BUSINESS PLAN | IDEATION STAGE | BILINGUAL EDITION

MirrorMind

Not a decision optimiser.
An identity clarifier with long-term memory.

不是帮你选最优解，而是帮你在太多身份里，先认出这段时间的自己，再做一个不那么后悔的小决定。



English

Part I — Full business plan in English, pp. 2-21

中文

第二部分 — 完整中文商业计划，见第 22-40 页

Ideation stage: this plan records the founders' ideas in full, with enhanced clarity and coherence, and adds product, design and business justification. No market outcome is claimed as proven. Every validation target in this plan is a hypothesis to be tested.

Contents and executive summary

Contents

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How to read this plan

This is an ideation-stage plan, not a fundraising deck with proven results. Its job is threefold: record every founder idea without omission, make the problem and opportunity legible to a business reader, and set out what will be validated first, and how.

Executive summary

MirrorMind is a self-knowledge and life-decision platform that combines artificial intelligence (AI) and psychology. It is built for high-school and university students at life turning points — choosing a school, a major, a first career direction, or whether to join a large company or start something of their own.

The platform does not start with advice. It starts with understanding. Through a light initial assessment and questions about upbringing, values, interests and life goals, MirrorMind builds an initial personal portrait. Then, through everyday chat, records of daily experience, emotions, dilemmas and important decisions, it builds an evolving personal model: personality, behaviour patterns, strengths and inner contradictions.

When a real decision arrives, MirrorMind does not list generic pros and cons. It reads the decision against that person's history, past decisions and what they truly value, explains why they are torn, tests fit through scenario simulation, and turns abstract anxiety into a concrete Action Plan and a small real-world experiment.

> **The core loop:** understand yourself, explore your future, then take action. Recording and sharing are why users return every day. Self-knowledge, decision simulation and action planning are where the lasting value is created, behind the scenes.

1 — THE PROBLEM

Students do not lack answers. They lack an anchor for who they are.

Ask a student what is wrong and they rarely say they lack information. They can list majors, salaries, rankings and other people's opinions in minutes. What they cannot do is answer a simpler question with confidence: given who I am, what fits me?

The founders' diagnosis is precise, and it is the centre of this plan: much of young people's confusion and anxiety comes from identity — either they cannot find an identity at all, or they have too many. One self is the major they study. Another is the self their family expects. Another is the self they perform on social media. Another is the self they privately want to become. When every choice has to satisfy all of those selves at once, a small decision — a course, an internship, a city — feels like a decision about an entire life. It stalls, and the stall itself becomes anxiety.

What this looks like in real life

- A student choosing a major is not choosing subjects. They are choosing which version of themselves is allowed to win.
- A graduate torn between a large company and a start-up is not comparing two offers. They are caught between safety they have been praised for and autonomy they have never tested.
- A student who changes direction feels they have wasted years, because no one helped them read their own history as evidence rather than as failure.

This is why generic advice fails. A pros-and-cons list treats preferences as fixed and known. In reality, as Judgment and Decision Making (JDM) research shows in the founders' framing, people often construct their preferences while deciding. They discover what they value by seeing their own past choices, reactions and trade-offs clearly. A tool that only optimises an answer skips the step that actually relieves the anxiety: making the person legible to themselves.

> **The pinpoint:** the unmet need is not better decision information. It is a low-cost, continuous way for a young person to build a trustworthy picture of themselves, and to borrow that picture when a hard decision arrives.

MirrorMind therefore solves two problems at once, in the founders' words: it addresses student confusion, and it addresses identity. Those are not two markets. They are the same moment, seen from outside and from inside.

2 — WHY NOW

The identity crisis is growing. In-person support is not growing with it.

This opportunity is getting larger, not smaller, for three reinforcing reasons.

1. Identity pressure arrives earlier and from more directions

Students now assemble an identity in public, under comparison, while they are still forming one in private. Social platforms reward a clear, presentable label — a personality type, a major, a career story — long before a young person has enough lived experience to know whether the label fits. The result is the paradox at the heart of MirrorMind: more identity labels than ever, and less identity certainty than ever. Labels give a moment of safety and something to show — "this is my type, these are my strengths" — but a fixed label cannot follow a person who is changing every semester.

2. Demand for support is rising faster than human supply

Schools and universities do provide counselling, and that work matters. The structural problem is capacity and timing. The founders identified the clearest version of this in the institutions they plan to serve: the student-to-teacher and student-to-counsellor ratios in tutoring institutions and student counselling centres are severely imbalanced. One counsellor cannot hold daily context for hundreds of students, cannot be present at 11 p.m. the night before a deadline, and cannot follow the small daily decisions where identity is actually formed. Support is therefore episodic, appointment-based and crisis-weighted, while student confusion is daily, low-grade and cumulative.

3. The missing middle is where most students live

Between "I am fine" and "I need formal counselling" sits the largest group: students who are anxious, lost or stuck on a decision, who would never book a counselling session, and who currently get help from friends, social media, horoscopes and personality tests. That middle has demand, frequency and willingness to share — and almost no product built for it with any psychological seriousness.

> **Boundary, stated plainly:** MirrorMind is low-cost support for everyday confusion, self-exploration and decisions. It is not psychotherapy, it does not diagnose, and it does not replace school counsellors or clinicians. That boundary is a business asset: it is what makes partnership with schools and counselling centres possible instead of competitive.

Technology closes this specific gap because the gap is one of continuity and cost, not of clinical depth. An AI personal agent can be present daily, remember context across months, and serve each additional student at low marginal cost. Human counsellors can then spend scarce time where human judgement is irreplaceable.

3 — FOUNDER ORIGIN

From decision science and life design, not from a chatbot template

MirrorMind began with the founders' interest in Judgment and Decision Making, and deepened through life coaching — in particular Stanford's *Designing Your Life* tradition, which treats a life direction as something to be prototyped and tested, not solved in one correct answer. Both roots are visible in the product: JDM supplies the account of why decisions feel hard and how preferences are formed; life design supplies the method — small prototypes, real experiments, reflection, then the next step.

The founders then argued with their own first idea, and that argument changed the company. If MirrorMind were only an AI that analyses personality, simulates a decision and produces an Action Plan, a person who already uses ChatGPT would have little reason to switch. A general chatbot can already produce a plausible analysis on demand. So the founders moved the product in two directions at once: toward a narrower, more emotionally connected audience — high-school and university students at turning points — and toward everyday use, so that understanding accumulates before a crisis, rather than being manufactured inside one.

How MirrorMind works — step 1: a first portrait, kept light

At the start, the user completes psychological assessments and answers questions about their upbringing and growth experience, values, interests and life goals. From this, MirrorMind forms an initial personal portrait. This portrait is a starting hypothesis, not a verdict. Its purpose is to give the first conversation something personal to build on, without pretending that a questionnaire can know a person.

Step 2: understanding built from real life, over time

After that, the user simply lives and records: chat, daily experiences, emotions, thoughts, dilemmas and important life moments. MirrorMind learns gradually from real material — personality, behaviour patterns, strengths, recurring tensions and inner contradictions — and maintains a personal model that keeps updating as the person changes. The model is earned from behaviour over time, which is precisely what a one-off test cannot provide.

> **Design consequence:** the theories stay in the background. Psychological and decision-making theory supports the model, the prompts and the simulations. The user sees a simple page, a conversation, and a next step — never a lecture.

When a decision arrives, the past does the work

Step 3: Decision Simulation grounded in the person

When the user faces anxiety about school progression, a major, a career or a life direction, MirrorMind brings the accumulated record to the decision. It runs a Decision Simulation: how each path fits this person's history, values and patterns; why the choice feels torn rather than merely difficult; and what evidence would actually change the answer.

The worked example the founders use

A graduate is torn between a large company and starting a business. A general chatbot lists the pros and cons of both — stability against autonomy, salary against risk — and leaves the user exactly as torn as before, because the list could belong to anyone. MirrorMind works differently. It asks what this person's past decisions show: when they thrived under structure and when they resented it; whether their stated love of freedom survived previous unstructured periods; what they actually valued in the experiences they rated highest; and which fear — failure, judgement, disappointing family, losing safety — is doing the real work in the dilemma. It then simulates each path as a lived scenario for this person, and proposes a small real-world experiment — for example a bounded side project, a structured shadowing period, or a defined trial with a review date — so the user can test fit in reality instead of endlessly simulating it in their head.

Step 4: an Action Plan that ends in a next step

The output is an Action Plan, but deliberately a small one: the next concrete attempt, what to observe, and when to review it. Abstract anxiety becomes something testable, and the result returns to the personal model.

1
Understand yourself

Initial portrait, then a personal model built from daily records, chat and decisions.

2
Explore the future

Scenario and Decision Simulation that test each path against your own history and values.

3
Act in real life

A small experiment and an Action Plan, reviewed afterwards so learning compounds.

4
Keep growing visibly

Milestones mark change over time, so growth can be seen, remembered and shared.

MirrorMind is therefore not a tool opened only when a problem erupts. It is a platform for daily recording, self-expression and exploring the future — with self-knowledge, simulation and planning working quietly underneath.

4 — EXPERIENCE PRINCIPLES

Emotional value decides whether anyone comes back

The founders' strongest product conviction is one many designers overlook: emotion matters more than correctness. A product that gives the objectively optimal decision but leaves the user feeling unseen, overwhelmed or more anxious has failed at the only test that decides frequent use — the experience. Users return to products that make them feel understood, steadied and a little clearer than when they arrived. Emotional value is therefore not decoration on MirrorMind. It is the retention mechanism, and the decision quality depends on it, because a calmer user records more honestly and experiments more willingly.

Against complexity: the failure mode of AI software

The market's AI products repeat the same mistake, in the founders' observation: they complicate. Powerful features are exposed all at once, flows become cumbersome, and users quietly abandon the product. MirrorMind deliberately leans the other way, toward entertainment and ease — light, playful and low-pressure on the surface, serious underneath.

A simple page as the differentiation

MirrorMind's interface starts from one simple page rather than separate screens for every function. Assessment, records, simulation and planning are not presented as a dashboard of tools competing for attention. Depth is placed in hidden features, triggered naturally through chat: when a user writes that they are torn, stuck or want to review a choice, the relevant capability appears inside the conversation. This gives the user a sense of participation and discovery — the product responds to what they actually said — instead of forcing them to learn a system before they can benefit from it.

> **UI/UX is the strategy, not the finish.** For MirrorMind, user retention is, in essence, interaction experience. If the experience is heavy, the personal model never accumulates and the decision value never materialises. If the experience is light and emotionally rewarding, the data, the model and the moat all follow.

What "simple" must still protect

- One primary action per moment: record today, in seconds.
- Hidden means discoverable in conversation, not buried — especially for Decision Simulation, which must be reachable when a real dilemma appears.
- Emotion first, analysis second: acknowledge what the user feels before offering any framework.
- Theory invisible: JDM and life-design methods shape the flow, never the wording the user has to decode.

People share identity. That sharing is the growth engine.

MirrorMind is designed to be wanted, opened and shared — to carry what the founders call shareability. The reference points are explicit: personality reporting in the style of MBTI, SBTI and horoscopes; the everyday authenticity of BeReal; and interactive, game-like milestones that can be shared.

Why identity content spreads

A good identity result does three things at once. It gives safety: a name for a confusing inner state. It gives expression: a compact way to say "this is me" without a long confession. And, honestly, it gives a little pride: "this is my type, and these are my strengths." MirrorMind uses all three, with one decisive difference from a static test. Its identity is a snapshot of a period — "who I am in this season" — built from real records and able to change. That makes it more truthful than a permanent label, and more interesting to share again as it evolves.

Share identity, never the diary

What is shared is the identity card and the milestone: a strength recognised, a pattern noticed, a decision made, an experiment completed. What is never shared by design is the raw diary — the private anxieties and records underneath. Users may choose to share selected moments with friends, or present their growth in a lighter, more playful form, but the private layer stays private. Without that separation, no one records honestly; with it, sharing becomes safe enough to become a habit.

Snowballing as low-cost distribution

Social sharing is not a vanity feature here. Effective sharing creates a snowball: one user's milestone card reaches friends who recognise the same confusion in themselves, at near-zero acquisition cost. For a student product with no large marketing budget, that loop is the distribution strategy, not an add-on to it.

The cold-start problem — and the founders' answer

The hard problem must be named. MBTI appears to understand you after a short set of questions, instantly. MirrorMind, to advise on a real life decision, needs far more context — and asking a new user to import a large amount of content up front is deeply discouraging. This is, in product terms, the context-window problem: the value needs depth, but the request for depth kills sign-up.

The answer is to trade time for data. Do not ask for a life on day one. Ask for thirty seconds today: one mood, one dilemma, one small decision. The initial portrait covers the first conversation; the daily habit builds the real model over weeks. Depth arrives as a by-product of a product users already enjoy, instead of as a toll charged at the door.

6 — COMPETITIVE POSITION

A personal agent, not a general chatbot

MirrorMind's clearest competitive claim is architectural. A general chatbot such as ChatGPT is a powerful question-answering tool: each conversation starts largely from what the user manages to explain in that moment. A personal agent — the model that Muse represents, a personal agent who knows and acts for one person over time — works from continuity. MirrorMind is built on the second model, and every advantage users feel in preferring a personal agent over a general chatbot transfers directly to MirrorMind.

General chatbot	MirrorMind as a personal agent
Answers the question you asked today	Answers in the context of who you have shown yourself to be over months
You must re-explain your background, values and history each time	Long-term memory holds your portrait, records and past decisions, so you never start from zero
Gives the same pros-and-cons list it would give anyone	Tests fit against your experiences, patterns, strengths and contradictions
Optimises the answer in front of it	Notices why you are torn, including fears and loyalties you did not state
Forgets the decision once the chat ends	Follows the experiment, reviews the outcome, and updates your personal model
A tool you consult	A relationship that compounds: every record makes the next conversation more personal
Value is in the single response	Value is in continuity, trust and being known — which is why users confide more honestly

That last row matters commercially. People tell a personal agent things they would not type into a blank, anonymous prompt, because the agent has earned context and returns it as care: it remembers what mattered last month and asks about it. That honesty is the input the personal model needs, and it cannot be copied by adding a longer prompt to a general chatbot. The moat is not a single feature. It is accumulated, consented, per-user understanding that grows more useful — and harder to leave — with time.

> **In one line:** ChatGPT can tell you what people in general should consider. MirrorMind helps you decide as the specific person your own history shows you to be.

7 — GO TO MARKET

Distribution is the hard part. Market validation comes first.

In the age of AI-assisted building — vibecoding — making a product is no longer the scarcest skill. Spreading it is. The founders' judgement is blunt: if the account does not take off, a beautifully built product has no meaning, because no one reaches it. The judges and investors who evaluate ventures like this are businesspeople; what they care about most is whether a product can truly go to market. MirrorMind's plan is therefore sequenced around proof of demand, not perfection of build.

Two tracks, run together

Track 1 — Product construction

Build a working prototype of the minimal loop: record, build a portrait over days, generate a shareable identity or milestone, and run one Decision Simulation ending in a small experiment.

Track 2 — Social operations

Build the audience and the evidence in parallel. The two tracks coexist by design: content discovers what students actually respond to, and those responses shape the product.

The Xiaohongshu-first sequence

- **Start an account with useful content, not an advert.** Begin with life-coaching methods and usable AI prompts — how to think through a dilemma, how to design a small life experiment — so the account earns attention on merit.
- **Then reveal the product.** Once the content has found its audience, transition to "we built a tool for this", with a link from Xiaohongshu to the prototype website.
- **Measure real use, in China first.** Use Xiaohongshu as the initial data source: content views, click-through to the prototype, first record completed, return within a week, identity or milestone shares, and users' own words about what helped.
- **Pitch with supporting data, not claims.** A prototype plus a large body of positive market data is enough at this stage. The product does not need to be fully polished; it needs to be wanted, used and shared, with the numbers to show it.

Content output must be continuous. A single launch post proves nothing; a sustained account proves a team can create demand repeatedly, which is exactly the capability business judges are pricing.

8 — BUSINESS MODEL

Easy to monetise, because the free habit and the paid value are different things

MirrorMind monetises cleanly because its layers separate naturally. The daily habit — recording, identity snapshots and shareable milestones — is light, frequent and social, and works as the free layer that drives acquisition and retention. The deep value — a richer personal model, full Decision Simulation, scenario work and structured Action Plans at major turning points — is infrequent, high-stakes and personal, and is what users and institutions pay for. Companies do not have to charge for the diary to charge for the decision.

Consumer revenue

- Freemium subscription: free recording, identity and milestone sharing; paid depth, including advanced personal-model reports, unlimited decision simulations and experiment tracking.
- Turning-point value: willingness to pay concentrates exactly where MirrorMind is strongest — school, major and career decisions that feel consequential.
- Retention supports subscription: a model that knows you over months is not a one-off purchase, and cancelling means leaving that accumulated understanding behind.

Institutional revenue — B2B2C

MirrorMind can be packaged for tutoring institutions and student counselling centres. The pitch to those buyers is capacity, not replacement. Their student-to-teacher ratios are severely imbalanced, so staff cannot provide daily, low-level guidance to every student. MirrorMind supplies the daily layer — recording, reflection, early noticing of confusion, and structured preparation before a human conversation — while counsellors keep the human conversations that matter most. Institutions gain reach and earlier visibility of struggling students; students gain continuity between appointments; MirrorMind gains distribution through a trusted channel and a buyer with a clear budget problem.

Why the economics work

- **Low marginal cost:** AI continuity serves each additional student cheaply, against a human-only model that scales only by hiring.
- **Low acquisition cost:** shareable identity and milestones snowball through friendship networks and Xiaohongshu content.
- **High frequency, high stakes:** daily use builds the asset, and life decisions supply the moments of paid value.
- **Compounding moat:** per-user personal models improve with time and do not transfer to a competitor.

Pricing, conversion and institutional fees are intentionally not fixed in this ideation plan. They are validation outputs: test willingness to pay once the prototype has real users, rather than inventing figures before demand is proven.

Validate the market before perfecting the product

Boundaries that protect users and the business

- **Not therapy:** no diagnosis, no treatment claims, no replacement for counsellors or clinicians. Clear signposting to human help when a user's content suggests they need it.
- **Privacy by separation:** share identity and milestones only, by user choice. Raw records and anxieties stay private.
- **Labels that can change:** identity is presented as a period snapshot, never a fixed verdict on a young person.
- **Depth without burden:** hidden features must remain easy to trigger in chat; the core record action stays at the surface.

Principal risks, stated honestly

- Cold start: if daily recording does not become a habit, the personal model stays thin. Mitigation: entertainment-leaning design, milestones and sharing from the first week.
- Being mistaken for entertainment astrology: if identity cards outrun real records, trust collapses. Mitigation: every shared identity claim is grounded in the user's own accumulated record.
- General chatbots adding memory: mitigation is focus — a student-specific, identity-first, shareable product and an institutional channel a general tool does not serve.
- Institutional caution on privacy and responsibility: mitigation is the boundary above, plus counsellor-in-the-loop positioning from the first conversation.

Ideation-stage roadmap

- **Phase 1 — Validate:** launch Xiaohongshu content on life-coaching methods and AI prompts; build the minimal prototype loop; link, measure and listen.
- **Phase 2 — Prove the loop:** show first record, weekly return, sharing and one completed decision experiment, in users' own words and in funnel data.
- **Phase 3 — Package:** take the validated loop to tutoring institutions and student counselling centres as a daily-support package.
- **Phase 4 — Deepen:** expand the personal model, simulations and paid depth only where Phase 2 proved demand.

> MirrorMind is a low-cost way to meet a growing need that human services alone cannot scale to meet: helping a young person, in the middle of too many possible selves, recognise who they are in this season — and take one real step as that person.

10 — ACADEMIC EVIDENCE

The era behind the product: Gen Z, information overload, and the collapse of the happiness U-curve

This section integrates the academic evidence behind the founders' claims into the plan, with in-text citations in APA style. It does not replace the founder narrative in Sections 1-9; it gives that narrative a theoretical model, experimental data, and an era context that a reader can check.

The collapse of the happiness U-curve (U-Curve Collapse)

For decades, cross-national psychological research consistently described life satisfaction as a U-shaped curve: highest in youth, lowest in middle age, and rising again in old age. The latest global well-being data indicate that, since 2017, this traditional curve has broken down (Helliwell et al., 2024). Young people aged 18-25 have, for the first time, become the age group with the lowest happiness and life satisfaction of any age group (Gallup, 2025; Helliwell et al., 2024).

Frequent psychological distress and a resource gap

Surveys cited in the founders' evidence pack report that 94% of Generation Z say they face mental-health struggles every month, 40% of young workers feel anxious or depressed several times a week, and 27% of young people under 30 have been diagnosed with clinical depression - a figure that has doubled since 2017 (Gallup, 2025; The Hartford, 2025). Traditional psychological services, by contrast, carry barriers of long waiting times and high cost (SAMHSA, 2022).

A stated preference for self-guided digital tools

In seeking relief from psychological stress, 47% of young people aged 18-34 turn to self-guided digital mental-health tools (Bipartisan Policy Center, 2025). Among users, 68% say explicitly that using a digital app or agent feels more comfortable and less pressured than speaking directly with a human counsellor, and 53% name low cost and affordability as their primary driver (Bipartisan Policy Center, 2025).

> **What this means for MirrorMind:** demand is rising fastest in exactly the group MirrorMind serves, human supply is not rising with it, and the format young people say they prefer - self-guided, digital, low-cost, low-pressure - is the format MirrorMind is built in.

Argument 1: Emotional value matters more than the objectively optimal decision

The founder claim: many designers ignore emotion. A product that provides emotional value matters more than one that objectively gives the optimal decision, because what decides whether a product is used often is, in the end, the experience.

Bounded rationality and the satisficing model

Under Herbert A. Simon's (1955, 1956) theory of bounded rationality, human computational capacity and cognitive resources are limited when facing complex reality. The classical economic assumption of pursuing an absolute mathematical optimum does not hold in real life; instead, individuals mainly use a satisficing strategy - searching for an option that is good enough, in order to conserve mental bandwidth (Simon, 1955, 1956; Thaler & Sunstein, 2008). Forcing users to compare objectively optimal options in an information-overloaded environment produces serious physiological and psychological stress (Duque et al., 2024).

The strength model of self-control and decision fatigue

The strength model proposed by Roy F. Baumeister and colleagues holds that self-regulation and rational decision-making draw on the same limited psychological resource (Baumeister et al., 1998; Vohs et al., 2008). As individuals make successive choices and evaluations, that resource is progressively depleted, producing decision fatigue (Baumeister et al., 1998; Polman & Vohs, 2016). Users in a state of decision fatigue behave characteristically: they become more impulsive, tend to keep the default option (default bias), procrastinate seriously over decisions, or abandon rational analysis altogether (Augenblick & Nicholson, 2016; Moorhouse, 2020; Pocheptsova et al., 2009).

> **Product implication:** a decision tool that demands more comparison from an already depleted user works against the user's own psychology. MirrorMind's satisficing stance - a good-enough, low-regret next step, held with emotional support - is the design the theory points to.

Argument 1, continued: Choice overload and emotional design

The choice overload hypothesis and the jam experiment

The classic experiment by Sheena S. Iyengar and Mark R. Lepper (2000) provides direct quantitative data:

- With 24 varieties of jam on offer (a large choice set), 60% of passers-by were attracted to stop, but the eventual purchase conversion rate was only 3%.
- With 6 varieties of jam on offer (a small choice set), 40% of passers-by stopped, but the purchase conversion rate reached 30%.
- In quantitative terms: reducing the number of options fourfold raised purchase conversion tenfold (Iyengar & Lepper, 2000).

Further research shows that too much choice forces the brain's comparison engine into operation, producing costly opportunity-cost rumination and subsequent regret, and thereby lowering satisfaction with the option finally chosen (Chernev et al., 2015; Schwartz, 2004).

Emotional design and the four pleasures

In Donald A. Norman's (2004) theory of emotional design, product experience is determined jointly by three levels: the visceral level, the behavioral level, and the reflective level. Traditional rational functionality satisfies only task efficiency at the behavioral level; what actually determines long-term retention, attachment, and frequent use is emotional resonance and self-identity at the reflective level (Norman, 2004).

Through a soothing interface and psychological support, a product can deliver psycho-pleasure (a sense of control and safety) and socio-pleasure (identity confirmation and belonging) (Norman, 2004). That emotional value acts effectively as a cognitive shield, preventing cold mathematical deduction from inflicting a second round of anxiety on young users who are already under high stress (Norman, 2004; Thaler & Sunstein, 2008).

Argument 2: A minimal page, with features hidden in conversation

The founder claim: a simple page is a differentiating starting point. Different functions can live in hidden features rather than in separate interfaces - for example, a hidden feature can be triggered through chat, giving the user a sense of participation.

The Hick-Hyman law

Under the Hick-Hyman law in cognitive psychology, the reaction time T an individual needs to make a decision rises logarithmically with the number of options n: $T = b \log_2(n + 1)$ (Hick, 1952; Hyman, 1953). In a minimal first-screen interface, reducing the number of visible options n to a very low level - a single dialogue box, for instance - greatly shortens cognitive hesitation and evaluation cost, and lowers visual information overload (Hick, 1952; Schwartz, 2004).

Progressive disclosure and conversational UX

In interaction design, progressive disclosure is a core mechanism for lowering a user's initial cognitive load by revealing complex functions step by step (Nielsen, 2006). Combined with conversational UX (CUX), the product replaces the deep, complex menu navigation of a traditional graphical user interface (GUI) with natural, turn-taking conversation (Gapsy Studio, 2025; Kulkarni, 2021). This design can identify user intent precisely and preserve context across sessions (context management), greatly lowering the cost of filtering information (Gapsy Studio, 2025).

Autonomy and competence in self-determination theory

Edward L. Deci and Richard M. Ryan's (1985, 2000, 2008) self-determination theory (SDT) holds that healthy psychological functioning depends on satisfying three basic psychological needs: autonomy, competence, and relatedness. Triggering or unlocking a hidden feature through chat - exploring it the way one finds an Easter egg - converts passive menu selection into an active exploration process (Deci & Ryan, 2000; Norman, 2004). This interaction pattern directly activates the user's sense of competence and autonomous control, and produces exploratory psycho-pleasure, building high engagement without adding to the cognitive burden of the first screen (Deci & Ryan, 2008; Norman, 2004).

Argument 3: Student confusion is an identity problem - overload, and no anchor

The founder claim: most of people's confusion and anxiety today comes from not finding an identity, or from having too many identities. The product must solve student confusion and provide identity at the same time - a low-cost way to ease a psychological problem.

Uncertainty-identity theory and entitative labeling

Social psychologist Michael A. Hogg's (2000, 2007, 2012) uncertainty-identity theory holds that self-uncertainty - vagueness about one's self-concept, values, and future direction - is one of the strongest psychological stressors human beings experience. When individuals face high uncertainty (as Gen Z students do at transitions in schooling, employment, and role) or face identity overload, the brain is strongly motivated to seek identity categories and labels with high entitativity and a clear prototype (Hogg, 2007, 2012; Wagoner & Hogg, 2017). Research indicates that establishing a clear identity prototype can directly mute neural activity in brain regions that process anxiety and stress responses (Jonas et al., 2014; Hogg, 2012).

Self-concept clarity and low-cost cognitive anchors

When a person's self-concept clarity is low, they urgently need external structured tools to define themselves (Hohman & Hogg, 2015). By using lightweight conversational guidance to help a confused student sort out and receive a provisional identity label - identity labeling - the product in effect acts as a low-cost cognitive stabilizer (Hogg, 2012; Hohman & Hogg, 2015). This explains why a lightweight agent can efficiently soothe students' identity anxiety without relying on expensive clinical services (Bipartisan Policy Center, 2025; Hogg, 2007).

> **Boundary, restated:** a cognitive stabilizer is daily support, not therapy. MirrorMind's identity labels are period snapshots that can change - never a fixed verdict - and the product does not diagnose or replace counsellors, as set out in Section 9.

Argument 4: Social sharing and snowballing - identity badging

The founder claim: a social quality matters, because effective snowballing through sharing is a low-cost medium of distribution.

Reflective design and socio-pleasure

In Norman's (2004) framework, socio-pleasure arises from interpersonal interaction and the expression of a social image. The underlying driver of a user's sharing product content on social media is not unpaid promotion for the product; it is self-image shaping (self-signaling), finding one's kind, and satisfying a need for social belonging (Deci & Ryan, 2000; Norman, 2004).

Identity badging and snowball virality

The success of Spotify Wrapped demonstrates the power of the identity badging mechanism: abstract personal behavior data are distilled and packaged into attractive identity-prototype cards (InterAI, 2025; Norman, 2004). The evidence pack cites data that the Spotify Wrapped mechanism drives more than 500 million spontaneous social-media shares every year (InterAI, 2025). The underlying logic is a virality condition: when sharing helps a user express precisely who they are, the network's viral coefficient (K-factor) can exceed 1. By providing high emotional value and identity confirmation, the product prompts users to diffuse their identity badges through their own social networks, achieving snowball virality at very low marginal cost (InterAI, 2025; Norman, 2004).

The positive computing framework

Rafael A. Calvo and Dorian Peters (2014), in their positive computing framework, argue that a new generation of digital products should abandon the utilitarian pattern of over-pursuing screen time and strongly induced clicks, and should instead focus design on raising users' self-awareness, psychological resilience, and agency (Calvo & Peters, 2014). Driving social distribution through positive identity empowerment fits the ethics of positive psychology and also secures long-term retention and word of mouth (Calvo & Peters, 2014).

Theory-to-product mapping

Founder idea / claim	Theoretical model	Key authors (APA)	Underlying psychological / neural mechanism
Emotional value over the rational optimum	Bounded Rationality & Decision Fatigue; Emotional Design Framework	Simon (1955); Baumeister et al. (1998); Norman (2004)	Cognitive depletion produces decision fatigue; reflective-level experience and psycho-pleasure determine long-term retention.
The jam experiment's conversion data	Choice Overload Hypothesis	Iyengar & Lepper (2000); Schwartz (2004)	24 options converted at 3%; 6 options converted at 30% (a tenfold rise); fewer choices reduce regret.
Minimal UI + chat-triggered hidden features	Hick-Hyman Law; Progressive Disclosure & CUX; Self-Determination Theory (SDT)	Hick (1952); Nielsen (2006); Deci & Ryan (2000)	Logarithmic reduction in reaction time; progressive disclosure hides complexity; exploring hidden features satisfies autonomy and competence.
Easing student confusion and identity need	Uncertainty-Identity Theory; Self-Concept Clarity	Hogg (2000, 2007, 2012); Hohman & Hogg (2015)	Self-uncertainty activates anxiety and stress; entitative identity labels can directly mute activity in brain regions processing anxiety.
Low-cost digital psychological support	Digital DTx & Self-Guided Mental Health Adoption	Bipartisan Policy Center (2025); Gallup (2025)	68% of young people find digital tools more comfortable than human counsellors; 53% name low cost as the primary driver.
Identity badges and snowball sharing	Identity Badging Mechanics; Positive Computing	Norman (2004); Calvo & Peters (2014); InterAI (2025)	Data turned into identity badges satisfies social expression (socio-pleasure) and drives spontaneous, low-cost virality (500 million+ shares case).

How to read this table: each row is a founder claim from Sections 4, 5, and 7, the model that supports it, and the mechanism that connects the two. Full references follow on the next two pages.

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目录与执行摘要

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如何阅读这份计划

这是一份构想阶段的商业计划，不是已经有成果的融资材料。它的任务有三件：完整记录创始人的全部想法，不遗漏任何细节；把问题和机会讲清楚，让做生意的人能看懂；说明接下来先验证什么、怎么验证。

执行摘要

MirrorMind 是一个结合 AI 与心理学的自我认知与人生决策平台，面向正处在人生转折点上的高中生和大学生：升学、选专业、第一份职业方向，以及毕业后去大公司还是创业。

它不从给建议开始，而是从理解一个人开始。用户先通过心理测评，回答关于成长经历、价值观、兴趣和人生目标的问题，AI 据此建立一个初步的个人画像。之后，用户通过日常聊天、记录日常经历、情绪、纠结和重要决定，让 AI 慢慢了解自己的性格、行为模式、优势和内在矛盾，形成一个不断更新的个人模型。

当真正的决定到来时，MirrorMind 不会像普通聊天工具那样只列出两个选项的优缺点。它会结合这个人过去的经历、做过的决定和真正重视的东西，分析他为什么纠结、不同选择与他的契合程度，再通过情境模拟和现实中的小实验，帮助他验证哪个方向更适合自己，最后落到一个具体的行动计划上。

> **核心闭环：**了解自己，探索未来，再做出实际行动。记录和分享，是用户每天愿意回来的原因；AI 的自我认知、决策模拟和行动规划，是在背后真正创造价值的部分。

1 — 真正的问题

学生不缺答案，缺的是一个能认出自己的锚点

问一个学生到底卡在哪里，他很少会说自己缺信息。专业、薪资、排名和别人的看法，他几分钟就能列出一大堆。他真正回答不了的，是一个更简单的问题：以我这个人来看，到底什么适合我？

创始人的判断很明确，也是这份计划的中心：现在年轻人的迷茫和焦虑，很大一部分来源于身份认同 — 要么找不到身份认同，要么身份太多了。一个我是所学的专业，一个我是家里期待的样子，一个我是在社交媒体上呈现的样子，还有一个我是自己私下真正想成为的样子。当每一个选择都要同时满足这几个我的时候，一个小决定 — 一门课、一次实习、一座城市 — 都会感觉像在决定整个人生。决定做不下去，停滞本身又变成新的焦虑。

在真实生活里，它长这样

- 一个选专业的学生，选的不是几门课，而是允许哪一个版本的自己赢。
- 一个在去大公司和创业之间纠结的毕业生，比较的不是两份工作，而是他一直被表扬的那种安全感，和他从来没有真正试过的自主感。
- 一个换了方向的学生，会觉得自己浪费了几年，因为没有人帮他把自己的过往读成证据，而不是失败。

这就是为什么泛泛的建议没有用。优缺点清单假设人的偏好是固定的、已知的。但按照创始人所依据的判断与决策（Judgment and Decision Making, JDM）的看法，人的偏好往往是在做决定的过程中才被建构出来的。人是在看清自己过去的选择、反应和取舍之后，才慢慢发现自己真正重视什么。一个只负责优化答案的工具，跳过了真正能缓解焦虑的那一步：让一个人能看懂自己。

> **问题 pinpoint：**没有被满足的需求，不是更好的决策信息，而是一种低成本、能持续的方式，让年轻人建立一幅可信的自我画像，并在艰难的决定到来时，借这幅画像来做决定。

所以 MirrorMind 同时解决两个问题，用创始人的话说：它解决学生的迷茫，也解决身份认同。这不是两个市场，而是同一个时刻，从外面看和从里面看的样子。

身份危机在变大，线下支持却没有跟着变多

这个机会正在变大，而不是变小，原因有三个，而且彼此加强。

一、身份压力来得更早，来源也更多

现在的学生是在公开比较中拼凑自己的身份的，同时他们私下那个身份还没有长好。社交平台奖励一个清晰、能展示的标签 — 一种人格类型、一个专业、一个职业故事 — 而这个时候，一个年轻人还没有足够的真实经历去判断这个标签到底合不合自己。结果就是 MirrorMind 正对着的那个矛盾：身份标签比任何时候都多，身份确定感比任何时候都少。标签能给人一瞬间的安全感，也能拿来展示，比如说我是这个类型、我的优点是什么。但一个固定的标签，跟不上一个每学期都在变的人。

二、支持的需求涨得比人力供给快

学校和大学确实有心理咨询，这份工作很重要。结构性的问题在容量和时机。创始人在计划服务的机构里看到了最清楚的版本：补习机构和学生咨询中心里，学生和老师、学生和咨询师的比例严重失衡。一位咨询师不可能为几百个学生保存每个人的日常上下文，不可能在截止日期前一天晚上十一点出现，也不可能跟住那些身份真正被形成的小决定。所以现实中的支持是按预约的、偶发的、偏向危机时刻的，而学生的迷茫是每天的、低强度的、不断累积的。

三、缺失的中间层，恰恰是大多数学生所在的地方

在"我没事"和"我需要正式咨询"之间，是最大的一群人：焦虑、迷茫、卡在一个决定上，但永远不会去预约一次咨询。他们现在向朋友、社交媒体、星座和人格测试求助。这一层有需求、有频率、也有分享意愿，却几乎没有一个带着心理学严肃性、专门为它做的产品。

> **边界，先讲清楚：**MirrorMind 是为日常迷茫、自我探索和决策提供的低成本支持。它不是心理治疗，不做诊断，也不替代学校咨询师和临床医生。这条边界本身就是商业资产：正因为划清了，它才能和学校、咨询中心合作，而不是和他们竞争。

技术能补的，正是这一段缺口，因为这段缺口缺的是持续性和成本，不是临床深度。一个 AI 个人智能体可以每天在场，可以记住几个月的上下文，每多服务一个学生，边际成本都很低。人力咨询师因此能把稀缺的时间，用在真正需要人类判断的地方。

来自决策科学和人生设计，不是来自聊天机器人模板

MirrorMind 最初的灵感来自 Judgment and Decision Making（判断与决策），之后又通过 life coaching（人生教练）方面的阅读加深，特别是斯坦福的《人生设计课》（Designing Your Life）这条传统：人生方向不是一次性算出正确答案，而是可以去做原型、去试、再调整的。两条根都在产品里：JDM 解释决定为什么难、偏好是怎么形成的；人生设计提供方法 — 做小的原型、做真实的实验、复盘、再走下一步。

然后创始人和自己的第一个想法吵了一架，而这一架改变了产品。如果 MirrorMind 只是做一个 AI，帮你分析性格、模拟决策、制定 Action Plan（行动计划），那对于本来就会用 ChatGPT 的人来说，其实没有太大的必要。一般的聊天工具当场就能给出一个像样的分析。所以创始人同时往两个方向改：一是面向更窄、情感连接更强的人群 — 正处在人生转折点的高中生和大学生；二是走向日常使用，让理解在危机到来之前就慢慢累积，而不是在危机里临时拼出来。

产品如何运作 — 第一步：第一幅画像，要轻

一开始，用户完成心理测评，回答关于成长经历、价值观、兴趣和人生目标的问题，MirrorMind 据此形成初步的个人画像。这幅画像是一个起始假设，不是一个判决。它的作用是让第一次对话就有一个属于这个人的起点，同时不假装一份问卷就能懂一个人。

第二步：理解来自真实生活，慢慢长出来

之后，用户只需要生活和记录：聊天、日常经历、情绪、想法、纠结和人生的重要时刻。MirrorMind 从真实材料里慢慢学习 — 性格、行为模式、优势、反复出现的张力和内在矛盾 — 并维护一个随着人变化而不断更新的个人模型。这个模型是从一段时间的行为里挣来的，这正是一次性测试给不了的东西。

> **设计上的结果：**理论留在后台。心理学和决策理论支撑模型、提问和模拟。用户看到的，只是一个简洁的页面、一段对话，和一个下一步，永远不需要先听一堂课。

决定到来的时候，让过去的自己来帮忙

第三步：以这个人为依据的决策模拟

当用户面对升学、专业、职业或人生方向的焦虑时，MirrorMind 会把累积下来的记录带进这个决定里，做 Decision Simulation（决策模拟）：每条路和这个人的经历、价值观、模式有多契合；这个选择为什么是纠结，而不只是难；以及什么样的证据真的能改变答案。

创始人一直用的那个例子

一个毕业生在去大公司和创业之间纠结。一般的聊天工具会列出两边的优缺点 — 稳定对自主、薪资对风险 — 然后用户和之前一样纠结，因为这张清单换谁都能用。MirrorMind 的做法不同。它会看这个人过去的决定说明了什么：他什么时候在有结构的环境里状态最好，什么时候又很抗拒；他嘴上说的热爱自由，在过去没有结构的阶段里到底撑没撑住；他给分最高的那些经历里，他真正重视的是什么；以及这场纠结里真正起作用的恐惧是哪一个 — 怕失败、怕被评价、怕让家里失望，还是怕失去安全感。之后，它把每条路模拟成这个人真正会过的生活，再提出一个现实中的小实验，比如一个有边界的副项目、一段有结构的跟岗观察期、或者一次有明确复盘日期的尝试，让用户在现实里验证契合度，而不是在脑子里无限模拟。

第四步：落到下一步的行动计划

输出是一份 Action Plan，但故意做小：下一个具体尝试、要观察什么、什么时候复盘。抽象的焦虑，由此变成可以去试的东西。实验结束，结果回到个人模型里，下一个决定就从更强的自我认知开始。

1
了解自己

先有初步画像，再用日常记录、聊天和决定，慢慢建立个人模型。

2
探索未来

情境模拟和决策模拟，用你自己的经历和价值观去试每一条路。

3
在现实里行动

一个小实验，一份行动计划，事后复盘，让学习累积起来。

4
让成长被看见

里程碑标记一段时间里的变化，让成长能被看见、被记住、被分享。

所以 MirrorMind 不是一个只有出问题时才打开的 AI 工具，而是一个年轻人愿意日常记录、表达自己、探索未来的平台。自我认知、决策模拟和行动规划，在背后安静地工作。

决定一个人会不会回来用的，是情绪价值

创始人最强的产品判断，是很多设计者会忽略的一点：情感很重要。能够提供情绪价值的产品，往往比客观给出最优决策的产品更重要。因为一个产品用户会不会经常用，到头来还是体验。一个产品哪怕给出了客观上最优的决定，但让用户觉得没有被看见、被信息压垮、甚至更焦虑，那它在唯一决定使用频率的测试上就是失败的。用户会回到那些让他们觉得被理解、被稳住、比进来时清楚了一点的产品。所以情绪价值在 MirrorMind 里不是装饰，它就是留存机制；决策质量也依赖它，因为一个更平静的用户，会记录得更诚实，也更愿意去做实验。

反对复杂化：AI 软件共同的失败方式

创始人观察到，市场上的 AI 软件容易犯同一个问题：把东西复杂化。强大的功能一次性全部摆出来，使用流程变得繁琐，用户就很容易抛弃使用。MirrorMind 故意往反方向走，靠近娱乐化：表面轻、好玩、低压力，底下保持严肃。

简洁页面，就是差异化

MirrorMind 的界面从一个简洁页面出发，而不是把每个功能拆成不同的界面。测评、记录、模拟和规划，不会以一排工具的样子互相抢注意力。深度被放进隐藏功能里，通过聊天自然触发：当用户写下自己在纠结、卡住、想复盘一个选择时，相应的能力就在对话里出现。这样用户有参与感和发现感 — 产品是在回应他真正说的话 — 而不是逼他先学会一套系统，才能得到好处。

> **UIUX 是最重要的。**对 MirrorMind 来说，用户留存本质上就是互动体验。体验一重，个人模型就累积不起来，决策价值也就不会出现。体验轻，而且情绪上有回报，数据、模型和壁垒就都会跟着来。

"简洁"必须守住的几件事

- 每一个时刻只有一个主要动作：今天记一下，只要几十秒。
- 隐藏不等于埋没：在对话里要能被发现，尤其是决策模拟，真正的纠结出现时必须够得着。
- 先情绪，后分析：先接住用户当下的感受，再给任何框架。
- 理论不可见：JDM 和人生设计的方法塑造流程，但不变成用户需要解码的语言。

人分享的是身份，而分享就是增长引擎

MirrorMind 要做得让人想打开、想分享，也就是创始人说的，让软件本身带有分享欲。参照点写得很明确：MBTI、SBTI、星座这类 reporting（报告式结果）；BeReal 那种日常真实感；还有更偏互动和游戏感的、可分享的里程碑。

为什么身份内容会传播

一个好的身份结果同时做三件事。它给安全感：为一种说不清的内在状态起一个名字。它给表达：用一个很短的形式说出"这就是我"，不用写一篇小作文。它也诚实地说，带一点展示和炫耀："我是这个类型，我的优点是这些。"MirrorMind 三件都用，但和静态测试有一个决定性的不同：它的身份是某一个阶段的快照 — "这段时间的我" — 来自真实记录，而且可以变。这让它比一个永久标签更真实，也因为它会变，反而更值得一次次分享。

晒身份，不晒日记

能被分享的是身份卡和里程碑：一个被认出的优势、一个被注意到的模式、一个做下的决定、一个完成的实验。设计上永远不被分享的，是底下的原始日记 — 那些私密的焦虑和记录。用户可以自己选择把部分时刻分享给朋友，或者用比较有趣的形式展示自己的成长，但私密层始终是私密的。没有这条分隔线，就没有人会诚实记录；有了它，分享才安全到能变成习惯。

Snowballing：低成本的传播媒介

社交属性在这里不是一个好看的功能。有效的分享会形成 snowballing（滚雪球）：一个用户的里程碑卡，传到同样在迷茫的朋友那里，获客成本接近零。对一个没有大市场预算的学生产品来说，这个循环就是分发策略本身，而不是分发之外的附加品。

冷启动问题 — 和创始人的解法

难的问题要直接说。MBTI 只需要回答一些问题，一下子就好像了解了你，而且是即时的。MirrorMind 要为人生决定给建议，需要多得多的上下文 — 而让一个新用户一上来大量 import（导入）内容，这个过程非常劝退。这在产品上就是 context window（上下文窗口）的问题：价值需要深度，但索取深度会把注册杀死。

解法是用时间换数据。第一天不要一个人的一生，只要今天的三十秒：一个情绪、一个纠结、一个小决定。初步画像撑起第一次对话，日常习惯在几周里把真正的模型建起来。深度变成一个用户本来就喜欢的产品的副产品，而不是在门口收的过路费。

6 — 竞争位置

是个人智能体，不是通用聊天机器人

MirrorMind 最清楚的竞争主张在架构上。像 ChatGPT 这样的通用聊天工具，是一个强大的问答工具：每次对话，基本都从用户当下能讲清楚的内容重新开始。个人智能体是另一种模式 — 以 Muse 为代表的那种，Muse 本质上是一个属于某一个人的 personal agent（个人智能体），长期地了解他、替他做事。MirrorMind 按第二种模式来建。用户之所以更愿意和 Muse 而不是 ChatGPT 说话的每一个理由，都可以直接变成 MirrorMind 的优势。

通用聊天机器人	MirrorMind 作为个人智能体
回答你今天问的这个问题	在你几个月里展现出来的那个自己里，回答这个问题
每次都要重新解释背景、价值观和过往	长期记忆保存画像、记录和过去的决定，永远不用从零开始
给出一张换谁都一样的优缺点清单	用你的经历、模式、优势和矛盾，去试每个选择的契合度
优化眼前的这个答案	注意到你为什么纠结，包括你没有说出口的恐惧和牵挂
对话结束，决定也被忘掉	跟进实验，复盘结果，并更新你的个人模型
是一个你来咨询的工具	是一段会累积的关系：每一次记录，都让下一次对话更懂你
价值在单次回答里	价值在持续性、信任和"被了解"里，所以用户会说得更诚实

最后一行在商业上很关键。人会把一些话告诉个人智能体，而不会打进一个空白的、匿名的输入框，因为这个智能体已经攒下了上下文，并把上下文以在乎的方式还回来：它记得上个月什么事对你重要，还会主动问起。这种诚实，正是个人模型需要的输入，而它不是给通用聊天工具加一段更长的 prompt（提示词）就能抄走的。壁垒不是某一个功能，而是按每个用户累积起来、经过同意的理解 — 用得越久越有用，也越难离开。

> **一句话：**ChatGPT 能告诉你，一般人应该考虑什么。MirrorMind 帮你以你自己的历史所显示的那个具体的人，来做这个决定。

7 — 进入市场

最难的不是把产品做出来，是传播；先验证市场

在 AI vibecoding（用 AI 快速把产品做出来）这个时代，把产品做出来已经不是最稀缺的能力了，传播才是。创始人的判断很直接：如果号起不来，软件做得再好也没有意义，因为没有人能到达它。评委和评估这类项目的投资人，底下都是 business man（做生意的人），他们最在意的其实就是这个产品可不可以真的 go to market（进入市场）。所以 MirrorMind 的顺序是围绕需求证据排的，而不是围绕把产品做得多完善排的。

两条线，并行推进

第一条线 — 软件构造

搭起最小闭环的原型（prototype）：记录、几天内形成画像、生成一张可分享的身份或里程碑、跑一次以小实验结尾的决策模拟。

第二条线 — 社交运营

同时把受众和证据建起来。两条线按设计就是可以 coexist（共存）的：内容发现学生真正有反应的是什么，这些反应再反过来塑造产品。

小红书优先的顺序

- **先起号，靠有用的内容，不靠广告。**可以先从 life coaching 的方法、好用的 AI 指令这类内容开始，让账号先靠价值被看见。
- **再转战到产品。**内容找到受众之后，再转到"我们做了一个软件"，在小红书放上网站链接，引导到原型。
- **先用国内的数据。**直接用小红书的国内数据做 supporting（支撑材料）：内容播放、点进原型的比例、完成第一次记录、七天内回访、身份或里程碑的分享，以及用户原话里说的体验。
- **Pitch 时拿数据说话。**这个阶段，有 prototype 加市场上有大量的 positive（正面）数据就好，不用做得特别完善。产品不需要先完美，它需要先被想要、被使用、被分享，而且有数据能证明。

内容输出必须持续。一次发布什么也证明不了；一个能持续产出的账号，证明的是这个团队能反复创造需求 — 而这正是做生意的人在给价格的能力。

容易变现，低成本补上人力补不上的那一层

为什么容易变现

MirrorMind 的几层天然分得开。日常习惯层 — 记录、身份快照、可分享的里程碑 — 轻、高频、带社交，适合做免费层，负责获客和留存。深度价值层 — 更丰富的个人模型、完整的决策模拟和重大转折点的行动计划 — 低频、高利害、非常个人，这才是付费的部分。公司不需要为日记收费，它为决定收费。

- **消费者收入：**免费记录、身份与里程碑分享；付费解锁深度，包括进阶个人模型报告、不限次数的决策模拟和实验追踪。付费意愿正好集中在升学、专业和职业这类重要决定上。一个用了几个月、已经懂你的模型，取消意味着丢掉累积的理解，这本身就支撑订阅。
- **机构收入 B2B2C：**打包给补习机构和 student counseling center（学生咨询中心）。卖点是补容量，不是替代人。他们的学生和老师比例严重失衡，老师不可能给每个学生日常陪伴。MirrorMind 提供日常层 — 记录、反思、更早注意到迷茫、在真人对话前做好准备；咨询师保留最重要的真人对话。机构获得覆盖面，学生获得两次预约之间的连续性，MirrorMind 获得可信渠道分发和预算问题清楚的买家。
- **经济模型成立的原因：**边际成本低，多服务一个学生很便宜，而纯人力只能靠招人扩；获客成本低，身份和里程碑通过朋友和小红书滚雪球；高频加高利害，日常积累资产，人生决定提供付费时刻；个人模型随时间变好，也搬不到竞品那里去。

定价、转化率和机构费用，在这份构想阶段计划里故意不定。它们是验证的产出：等原型有了真实用户，再测付费意愿，而不是在需求被证明之前编数字。

边界与风险

- 不是治疗：不诊断、不做治疗承诺、不替代咨询师和临床医生；当用户内容显示他们需要真人帮助时，清楚地指引到真人支持。
- 隐私靠分隔：只分享身份和里程碑，且由用户自己决定；原始记录和焦虑保持私密。
- 标签可以变：身份永远呈现为一个阶段的快照，绝不是给一个年轻人下的固定判决。
- 主要风险是冷启动、被误认成娱乐算命、通用工具补上记忆，以及机构对隐私和责任的谨慎。解法在前面几节：轻设计和第一周里程碑；每条身份结论都要有真实记录做依据；学生专属加机构渠道；从第一次合作起就坚持咨询师在环内。

构想阶段路线图

- **第一阶段 — 验证：**小红书先发 life coaching 方法和 AI 指令内容起号；搭最小原型闭环；放链接、测数据、听用户。
- **第二阶段 — 证明闭环：**用漏斗数据和用户原话，证明第一次记录、一周回访、分享和一次完成的决策实验。
- **第三阶段 — 打包：**把验证过的闭环，打包给补习机构和学生咨询中心，做日常支持方案。
- **第四阶段 — 加深：**只在第二阶段证明有需求的地方，扩展个人模型、模拟和付费深度。

> MirrorMind 用低成本，补上一个正在变大、而人力服务单独无法规模化满足的需求：帮一个在太多可能的自己之间迷茫的年轻人，认出这段时间的自己，并以这个自己的样子，迈出真实的一步。这也是它低成本解决学生心理困扰的方式 — 不是替代专业帮助，而是让日常的支持，第一次变得人人够得着。

产品背后的时代背景：Z世代、信息过载与幸福感 U 型曲线的坍塌

这一节把创始人论点背后的学术证据整合进计划，正文引用采用 APA 格式。它不替代第 1-9 节的创始人叙事，而是为这套叙事补上读者可以核查的理论模型、实验数据和时代背景。

幸福感 U 型曲线的坍塌

在过去数十年中，全球跨国心理学研究一致表明，人类的生活满意度呈 U 型曲线：青年期最高，中年期陷入低谷，老年期回升。然而，最新的全球幸福感数据表明，自 2017 年起，这一传统曲线已彻底破裂 (Helliwell et al., 2024)。18-25 岁的青年群体，首次成为全年龄段中幸福感与生活满意度最低的群体 (Gallup, 2025; Helliwell et al., 2024)。

高频心理困境与资源缺口

创始人提供的证据材料引用的调查显示，94% 的 Z 世代表示每月都会面临心理健康困境，40% 的年轻职场人每周多次感到焦虑或抑郁，27% 的 30 岁以下青年曾被确诊临床抑郁症，较 2017 年翻倍 (Gallup, 2025; The Hartford, 2025)。然而，传统心理诊疗存在排期长、费用高昂等壁垒 (SAMHSA, 2022)。

对自导式数字工具的替代偏好

在寻求缓解心理压力的途径中，47% 的 18-34 岁青年转向自导式数字心理健康工具 (Bipartisan Policy Center, 2025)。68% 的使用者明确表示，相比直接与人类咨询师沟通，使用数字 APP 或智能体让他们感到更加舒适与无压力；53% 的人将低成本、价格亲民作为首要驱动因素 (Bipartisan Policy Center, 2025)。

> **这对 MirrorMind 意味着什么：**需求增长最快的，正是 MirrorMind 服务的人群；人力供给没有跟着增长；而年轻人明确说自己偏好的形式——自导、数字、低成本、低压力——正是 MirrorMind 的产品形式。

论点一：情绪价值比客观最优决策更重要

创始人的论点：很多设计者忽略了情感。能够提供情绪价值的产品，往往比客观给出最优决策更重要，因为什么样的产品用户会经常用，到头来还是体验。

有限理性与满意决策模型

根据 Herbert A. Simon (1955, 1956) 的有限理性理论，人类大脑在面对复杂现实时，计算能力与认知资源是受限的。传统经济学假设的追求绝对数学最优解在现实中并不成立；相反，个体在日常生活中主要采取满意决策策略，即寻找一个足够好的选项，以节省心理带宽 (Simon, 1955, 1956; Thaler & Sunstein, 2008)。强迫用户在信息过载的环境中对比客观最优解，会导致严重的生理与心理应激 (Duque et al., 2024)。

自我控制能量模型与决策疲劳

Roy F. Baumeister 及其同事提出的自我控制能量模型指出，人的自我调节与理性决策依赖于同一种有限的心理资源 (Baumeister et al., 1998; Vohs et al., 2008)。当个体进行连续的选择与评估时，这种心理资源会被逐步消耗，引发决策疲劳 (Baumeister et al., 1998; Polman & Vohs, 2016)。处于决策疲劳状态下的用户，行为特征表现为：更容易冲动，倾向于维持默认选项，产生严重的决策拖延，或放弃理性分析 (Augenblick & Nicholson, 2016; Moorhouse, 2020; Pocheptsova et al., 2009)。

> **产品含义：**一个要求已经被消耗的用户再做更多对比的决策工具，是在和用户自己的心理机制对着干。MirrorMind 的做法——给一个足够好、不那么后悔的下一步，并配上情绪支持——正是理论指向的设计。

论点一（续）：选择过载与情感设计

选择过载假说与果酱实验

Sheena S. Iyengar 与 Mark R. Lepper (2000) 的经典实验，提供了直接的量化数据：

- 在提供 24 种果酱的条件下（高选择集），虽然吸引了 60% 的过路客，但最终购买转化率仅为 3%。
- 在提供 6 种果酱的条件下（低选择集），吸引了 40% 的过路客，但最终购买转化率高达 30%。
- 量化来看：选项减少 4 倍，购买转化率提升了 10 倍 (Iyengar & Lepper, 2000)。

进一步研究表明，过多的选择会强制启动脑内的对比引擎，产生高额的机会成本反刍与事后悔恨，从而降低对最终选择的满意度 (Chernev et al., 2015; Schwartz, 2004)。

情感设计理论与四种愉悦感

Donald A. Norman (2004) 在其情感设计理论中指出，产品的体验由三个层级共同决定：本能层、行为层与反思层。传统的理性功能仅满足了行为层的任务效率，但真正决定用户长期留存、依恋与高频调用的，是反思层的情感共鸣与自我认同 (Norman, 2004)。

产品通过舒缓界面与心理支持，满足心理愉悦（获得掌控与安全感）与社交愉悦（身份确认与归属感）(Norman, 2004)。这种情绪价值有效地充当了认知屏障，避免了冷冰冰的数学推演给处于高应激状态的年轻用户带来二次焦虑 (Norman, 2004; Thaler & Sunstein, 2008)。

论点二：极简页面，与藏在对话里的隐藏功能

创始人的论点：简洁页面是一个差异化的出发点。可以把不同功能放在隐藏功能里面，而不是分开做成不同界面，比如通过聊天触发某个隐藏功能，让用户有参与感。

席克法则

根据认知心理学中的 Hick-Hyman Law，个体做出决策所花费的反应时间 T 与选项数量 n 呈对数关系：$T = b \log_2(n + 1)$ (Hick, 1952; Hyman, 1953)。在首屏极简的界面中，将可见选项数量 n 降至极低，比如单一对话框，能够大幅缩短用户的认知迟滞与评估消耗，降低视觉信息过载 (Hick, 1952; Schwartz, 2004)。

渐进式呈现与对话式交互

在交互设计领域，渐进式呈现是一种通过逐步展示复杂功能来降低用户初始认知负荷的核心机制 (Nielsen, 2006)。结合对话式交互，对话式 UX 用自然的轮流对话，替代了传统图形界面中深层且复杂的菜单导航 (Gapsy Studio, 2025; Kulkarni, 2021)。这种设计能够精确识别用户意图，并保留跨会话上下文，大幅降低信息筛选成本 (Gapsy Studio, 2025)。

自我决定理论中的自主感与胜任感

Edward L. Deci 与 Richard M. Ryan (1985, 2000, 2008) 的自我决定理论表明，人类健康的心理机能依赖于三种基本心理需求的满足：自主感、胜任感与归属感。通过聊天交互去触发或解锁隐藏功能，如同探索彩蛋，能将被动接受菜单转化为主动探索过程 (Deci & Ryan, 2000; Norman, 2004)。这种交互模式直接激活用户的胜任感与自主控制感，带来探索性的心理愉悦，在不增加首屏认知负担的前提下，建立很高的互动参与感 (Deci & Ryan, 2008; Norman, 2004)。

论点三：学生的迷茫是身份问题——身份过载，与没有锚点

创始人的论点：现在人的迷茫和焦虑，大部分来源于找不到身份认同，或者是身份太多了。产品既要解决学生迷茫，又要提供身份认同，低成本解决心理问题。

不确定性-身份理论与实体化标签

社会心理学家 Michael A. Hogg (2000, 2007, 2012) 提出的不确定性-身份理论指出，自我不确定性，即对自我概念、价值观以及未来方向的模糊感，是人类最强烈的心理应激源之一。当个体处于高度不确定性时，如面临升学、就业与角色转换的 Z 世代学生，或面临身份过载时，大脑会产生强烈的动机，去寻找具有高实体性与清晰原型的身份分类与标签 (Hogg, 2007, 2012; Wagoner & Hogg, 2017)。研究表明，确立明确的身份原型，能够直接抑制大脑中负责处理焦虑与应激反应的神经区域的活动 (Jonas et al., 2014; Hogg, 2012)。

自我清晰度与外部心理锚点

当个人的自我概念清晰度处于低位时，个体急需依靠外部结构化工具来进行自我定义 (Hohman & Hogg, 2015)。产品通过轻量化的对话引导，帮迷茫的学生梳理并赋予一个阶段性的身份标签，实际上充当了低成本的认知稳定剂 (Hogg, 2012; Hohman & Hogg, 2015)。这解释了为什么轻量化的智能体能在不依靠昂贵诊疗的前提下，高效舒缓学生的身份认同焦虑 (Bipartisan Policy Center, 2025; Hogg, 2007)。

> **边界，再说一次：**认知稳定剂是日常支持，不是治疗。MirrorMind 的身份标签是会变的阶段快照，绝不是固定判决；产品不诊断、不替代咨询师，这一点已在第 9 节写明。

论点四：社交属性与滚雪球传播——身份徽章

创始人的论点：有社交属性确实挺重要，因为有效的滚雪球分享，是低成本传播的一个媒介。

反思层设计与社交愉悦

在 Norman (2004) 的框架中，社交愉悦源于人际互动与社交形象的表达。用户在社交媒体上分享产品内容的底层驱动力，并非为产品做无偿宣传，而是为了进行自我形象塑造、寻找同类，以及满足社交归属感 (Deci & Ryan, 2000; Norman, 2004)。

身份徽章与滚雪球裂变机制

以 Spotify Wrapped 为代表的成功案例，展示了身份徽章机制的威力：将抽象的个人行为数据重新提炼并封装为美观的身份原型卡片 (InterAI, 2025; Norman, 2004)。证据材料引用的数据称，Spotify Wrapped 机制每年驱动超过 5 亿次自发社交媒体分享 (InterAI, 2025)。其底层逻辑是一个传播条件：当分享行为能够帮用户精准表达我是谁时，网络传播的病毒系数 K 值可以大于 1。通过提供高情绪价值与身份确认，产品促使用户将身份徽章自发扩散到社交网络，实现极低边际成本的滚雪球式裂变 (InterAI, 2025; Norman, 2004)。

正向计算框架

Rafael A. Calvo 与 Dorian Peters (2014) 在其正向计算理论中强调，新一代数字产品应当摒弃过度追求屏幕停留时长、强诱导点击的功利主义模式，转而将设计重点放在提升用户的自我意识、心理韧性与主体性上 (Calvo & Peters, 2014)。通过正向的身份赋能驱动社交传播，既符合正向心理学伦理，又能获得长期的用户留存与口碑 (Calvo & Peters, 2014)。

理论模型与产品映射汇总表

产品构想 / 论点	对应的理论模型	核心代表学者 (APA)	心理学 / 神经科学底层机制
情绪价值大于理性最优解	有限理性与决策疲劳；情感设计框架	Simon (1955); Baumeister et al. (1998); Norman (2004)	认知消耗引发决策疲劳；反思层体验与心理愉悦决定长期留存。
果酱实验的数据转化	选择过载假说	Iyengar & Lepper (2000); Schwartz (2004)	24 种选项转化率 3%，6 种选项转化率 30%，提升 10 倍；选择减少可降低悔恨感。
极简界面 + 聊天触发隐藏功能	席克法则；渐进式呈现与对话式 UX；自我决定理论	Hick (1952); Nielsen (2006); Deci & Ryan (2000)	对数级降低反应时间；渐进呈现隐藏复杂度；探索隐藏功能满足自主感与胜任感。
缓解学生迷茫与身份认同	不确定性-身份理论；自我概念清晰度	Hogg (2000, 2007, 2012); Hohman & Hogg (2015)	自我不确定性激活焦虑应激；实体化身份标签能直接抑制大脑焦虑区域活动。
低成本数字心理支持	数字疗法与自导式心理健康采用	Bipartisan Policy Center (2025); Gallup (2025)	68% 的年轻人认为数字工具比人类咨询师更舒适，53% 视低成本为首要驱动。
身份徽章与滚雪球传播	身份徽章机制；正向计算	Norman (2004); Calvo & Peters (2014); InterAI (2025)	数据转化为身份徽章，满足社交表达，驱动自发低成本裂变（5 亿+分享案例）。

如何读这张表：每一行是第 4、5、7 节中的一个创始人论点，支撑它的模型，以及连接两者的机制。完整参考文献见后两页。

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